CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. What is the effect of Horace's hay fever/cold in the plot? 1

(a) it adds comedy and shows human weakness **(b)** it kills him

(c) it hides him **(d)** it solves the case

2. In literary terms the woman is a ___ to Horace. 1

(a) foil **(b)** hero **(c)** minor extra **(d)** narrator

3. The word 'impostor' means: 1

(a) a servant **(b)** a friend

(c) a policeman **(d)** a person who pretends to be someone else

4. Which quality of the woman does the story admire? 1

(a) none; it is humorous about her cunning **(b)** her kindness

(c) her honesty **(d)** her wealth

5. Which is the best critical comment on the plot? 1

(a) it has no plot

(b) it has many twists

(c) its neat reversal depends on a convenient coincidence

(d) it is a novel

6. What does the story suggest about the relationship between law and justice? 1

(a) justice is cruel

(b) law always fails

(c) justice can be ironic and law may punish the less clever

(d) law is unfair

7. Why might the story be called a 'comedy of errors'? 1

(a) there are twins

(b) there is a storm

(c) mistaken trust leads to a series of comic misfortunes

(d) there is a wedding

8. The sentence 'Had Horace left no fingerprints, he would not have been caught' is: 1

(a) a future simple **(b)** a passive
(c) a question **(d)** a third conditional with inversion

9. Which narrative technique is used in the opening? 1

(a) introducing the character's double life **(b)** a dream
(c) a letter **(d)** a flashback

10. A reader who calls Horace 'naive' is mainly noting his: 1

(a) failure to doubt a convenient story **(b)** love of books
(c) skill with locks **(d)** age

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why is Horace's love of books ironic given his crime? 2

12. Analyse the narrative voice. 2

13. Evaluate the effectiveness of the ending. 2

14. What is the significance of the fingerprints? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. What does the story reveal about the psychology of trust? 3

16. Compare the beginning and ending of the story. 3

17. Evaluate the role of humour in making the moral acceptable. 3

OR

Examine the contrast between the two thieves. 3

18. Discuss the villain's role in advancing the theme. 3

OR

What is the importance of the real owner's denial? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write an essay on 'The danger of easy trust in a digital age', drawing on the story. 5

OR

How does the writer make a thief into a likeable character? 5

20. Compare the use of humour in this story with that in 'A Triumph of Surgery'. 5

OR

Discuss the role of coincidence and planning in the story. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND